

ALI RAZZAQ

LINUX SYSTEM ENGINEER II



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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Linux System Engineer with over 6 years of technical expertise in the deployment, configuration, patch management, and lifecycle maintenance of enterprise-grade Linux systems, including RHEL, CentOS and Ubuntu. Skilled at architecting, implementing, and optimizing IT infrastructure across virtualized and physical environments. Extensive experience with automation and orchestration tools such as Ansible, version control with Git. Proven ability in managing cloud platforms, particularly AWS, exposed to containerization using Docker. Specializing in advanced storage management, file systems, virtualization technologies, and network configuration. Recognized for ensuring high availability, performance tuning, and system reliability in complex, mission critical environments.

ADDITIONAL SKILLS

| **Operating Systems** | RHEL, CentOS, OEL, Debian, Windows | | **Version Control** | Git, Gitlab, Bitbucket | | **Automation & Scripting** | Ansible, Ansible Tower, RAAP, Bash Scripting | | **Networking** | TCP/IP, SMTP, TFTP, FTP, NFS, DNS, DHCP, Telnet, NIC Teaming, Tcpdump, dig | | **Storage Management** | LVM, RAID, SAN | | **File Systems** | EXT3, EXT4, XFS | | **Server Provisioning** | PXE-Boot, Kickstart | | **Performance & System Tools** | Top, Free, Ping | | **Security** | Iptables, SELinux, SSH, Cron, Logs | | **Cloud Services** | Amazon Web Services (EC2, EBS, ELB, IAM, AMI), Security Groups, CloudWatch, Autoscaling, Route53, VPC | | **Monitoring & Ticketing Tools** | Splunk, Nagios, Senso, Jira, Service Now, BMC Remedy | | **Virtualization** | VMware, vSphere, Vcenter, ESXI Snapshots, Clones, HA, FT | | **Package Management** | YUM, RPM, Red hat Satellite | | **Web & FTP Services** | VSFTPD, HTTP, Apache, Nginx, Tomcat | | **Containers & Orchestration** | Docker, Kubernetes | | **User Management** | User Accounts, Permissions | | **Database Management** | MySQL, MariaDB |

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Wells Fargo, NYC, NY

Linux Systems Engineer II

May 2022 – Present

- Developing and managing Virtual Machine templates, orchestrated provisioning, and conducted detailed configuration and real-time monitoring of ESXI hosts via vCenter, ensuring high availability and resource optimization.
- Performing end-to-end decommissioning processes for physical and virtual Linux servers, following stringent security protocols and industry best practices to ensure effective resource recovery and data sanitization.
- Managing and streamlining source code version control using Git, performing repository management, version tracking, and ensuring collaboration via GitHub.
- Automated Git operations using custom scripts to improve development efficiency.
- Executing precise and efficient system updates and configuration changes through the use of Ansible ad-hoc commands, improving operational agility and system management.

- Creating Ansible playbooks ranging from simple to advanced, incorporating handlers, tags, registers, and vaults, delivering secure, scalable, and automated solutions tailored to complex operational requirements.
- Utilizing Ansible Tower for centralized automation management, simplifying credential management and optimizing inventory control through an intuitive graphical interface.
- Configured NIC bonding (channel bonding) to ensure fault tolerance, load balancing, and redundancy in network configurations, enhancing system reliability and uptime.
- Effectively utilizing the ServiceNow ticketing system to track, manage, and resolve incidents, adhering to SLAs and maintaining high operational efficiency.
- Spinning up and managing AWS EC2 instances, including creating and managing Amazon Machine Images (AMIs), security groups, IAM roles, and policies to support scalable and resilient cloud environments.
- Using customized AMIs, automating instance scaling and optimizing resource allocation through dynamic Auto Scaling Groups.
- Delivering comprehensive Docker host, registry, and container management, ensuring smooth containerized application deployments and troubleshooting Docker Engine issues as required.
- Working with Docker Compose for advanced container orchestration and lifecycle management on single-host environments, optimizing deployment processes, resource allocation, and service scalability.
- Experience in leveraging Kubernetes for pod deployment and application performance monitoring, ensuring system reliability and application uptime.
- Proactively maintaining essential system services and monitoring application availability, ensuring continuous uptime through rigorous system monitoring and timely intervention.
- Employing Prometheus and Grafana to implement infrastructure monitoring. Dashboards and alerting systems were made in order to proactively identify and address performance bottlenecks.

Hewlett Packard Enterprise, Spring, TX

Linux/ Unix Admin

May 2019 – April 2022

- Experience with the full lifecycle management of Linux systems, including planning, deployment, and operational support, ensuring optimal system performance across production, development, and QA environments.
- Installed, configured, and maintained Red Hat Enterprise Linux (RHEL) and CentOS 6/7/8 servers, delivering enterprise-level support with a focus on high availability, security, and scalability.
- Demonstrated expertise in Red Hat Satellite for system upgrades, configuration management, patch automation, and lifecycle management of Red Hat infrastructure.
- Diagnosed and resolved operating system issues, particularly during and after patching activities, minimizing downtime and ensuring system stability.
- Proficient in Logical Volume Management (LVM), handling the creation and management of Volume Groups, Logical Volumes, and disk mirroring, and resolving issues related to stale or incomplete mirrored volumes.
- Configured and automated mount points using Autofs and FSTAB, ensuring efficient and reliable access to server directories and storage resources.
- Managed secure file transfers using SCP, SFTP, and FTP protocols, ensuring data integrity and compliance with security standards during transmission.
- Expert in user management, file permissions, ownership configurations, and sudo privilege management to maintain system security and enforce least-privilege policies.
- Created and maintained file systems (EXT3, EXT4, and XFS) based on organizational storage needs, ensuring efficient utilization and performance of storage resources.
- Monitored and maintained the health of backup servers, collaborating with the backup team to ensure the integrity and availability of critical data.
- Configured and managed NFS with automounting to facilitate seamless file sharing and access across networked systems.

- Generated and deployed SSH keys to enable secure, password-less access to Linux servers, enhancing operational efficiency and system security.
- Optimized system performance by fine-tuning Linux kernel parameters such as virtual memory, file system caching, and network stack tuning, enhancing system stability, reducing latency, and maximizing resource efficiency in production environments.
- Installed, configured, and troubleshoot Apache web servers, ensuring continuous availability, security, and performance for web applications.
- Configured and managed host-based firewall rules using IP Tables, strengthening network security by preventing unauthorized access and mitigating security risks.
- Analysed and monitored network traffic using advanced tools such as Wireshark and tcpdump, precisely diagnosing and resolving network performance issues and bottlenecks.
- Automated repetitive system administration tasks through Shell scripting, significantly improving efficiency, minimizing manual intervention, and reducing the potential for human error.

Data Prise, NYC, NY

Linux Support Technician

September 2018 – April 2019

- Conducted comprehensive software and hardware installations, including server setup and cabling, to ensure smooth infrastructure deployment.
- Liaised with third-party vendors to negotiate hardware repairs and replacement, ensuring timely resolutions and minimizing downtime.
- Created and managed hard links and soft links in Linux environments to optimize file management and improve system performance.
- Configured and managed automated tasks using Cron, scheduling regular maintenance jobs and system tasks through Crontab.
- Installed and configured wireless networking equipment and associated network software, optimizing connectivity and ensuring network stability.
- Utilized the Linux TAR utility to create reliable data backups, ensuring the protection and availability of critical information.
- Analysed and managed system log files, performing cleanups to free up disk space and maintain server performance.
- Installed, upgraded, and managed software packages using YUM and RPM package management utilities, ensuring systems remain up-to-date with the latest features and security patches.

EDUCATION

2013

Bachelor in Commerce

University of the Punjab, Pakistan